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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

21109

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of the NSC Principals Committee

DATE: September 21, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 2:30 - 4:00 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

Chair

Anthony Lake

CIA

John Deutch

Dennis Blair

OVP

Leon Fuerth

Rick Saunders

JCS

General Shalikashvili

Wesley Clark

State

Secretary Christopher

Peter Tarnoff

Delegation

Richard Holbrooke

Christopher Hill

DOD

John White

Walter Slocombe

Roberts Owen

James Pardew

Donald Kerrick

USUN

Ambassador Albright

David Scheffer

White House

Sandy Berger

Nancy Soderberg

OMB

Alice Rivlin

Gordon Adams

NSC

Sandy Vershbow

Chief of Staff

Leon Panetta

Summary of Conclusions

1. Principals received a briefing by the U.S. negotiating team on the progress of the U.S. diplomatic initiative since their last meeting on September 11. They welcomed plans to hold a second meeting of the Foreign Ministers of Bosnia, Croatia and Serbia with the Contact Group on September 26 in New York, at which the three parties would likely endorse further agreed

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principles for a Bosnia settlement. Principals agreed that the New York Foreign Ministers' meeting should be announced by the White House later that day as part of a statement on behalf of the President following his telephone briefing by Secretary Christopher, National Security Advisor Lake and Ambassador Holbrooke. (Action: NSC) ~~(C)~~

2. Principals noted concerns by the U.S. negotiating team about growing tensions within the Federation and between the Governments of Bosnia and Croatia in the wake of their recent territorial gains in western Bosnia. They agreed that a high-level demarche should be made to Croatian President Tudjman warning of the consequences of his failure to support the Federation. It was subsequently agreed that the President would phone German Chancellor Kohl to urge that he make a similar demarche to Tudjman. (Action: State and NSC) ~~(S)~~

3. Principals agreed that the recent territorial shifts in western Bosnia may have improved the chances for a settlement. But they agreed that further offensives could jeopardize this progress, especially if they led to large Serb refugee flows, and that we should place renewed emphasis on the need for all parties to show restraint. Principals agreed that we should encourage the Bosnians to consider a limited-duration country-wide cessation of hostilities that would preserve their recent gains while negotiations on a final settlement proceeded. ~~(S)~~

4. Principals noted that NATO air strikes had had a positive impact on Serb attitudes toward a peace settlement. They agreed that we should make clear that the bombing would resume if the Serbs did not comply with the UN/NATO conditions and that we should press the UN to allow access for Bosnian civilian traffic into Sarajevo in order to test Milosevic's commitment to ensure complete freedom of movement. (Action: State/USUN) ~~(S)~~

5. Principals agreed it was still premature to take any decision regarding the timing and venue of an international conference. This should be revisited based on the results of the September 26 meeting of the Balkan Foreign Ministers and the next round of shuttle diplomacy by the U.S. negotiating team. ~~(C)~~

6. Principals reviewed continuing difficulties in persuading our key allies to include the Italians in consultations on the peace process. They agreed we should urge the Italians to organize the expanded Contact Group meeting in Rome that had been discussed previously and that we should also press to include Italy in five-power consultations on military planning for peace plan implementation. (Action: State) ~~(C)~~

7. Principals received an update from General Shalikashvili on NATO planning for the implementation force (IFOR). They agreed

that we would likely want to follow the Haiti model -- i.e., insert a large and heavily-equipped force at the very outset in order to deter non-compliance by the parties but then phase down the force quickly once stable conditions have been established. They agreed in principle that we should be flexible on modalities for linking Russian forces to the IFOR, so long as the single NATO chain of command was preserved, with no UN dual key. ~~(S)~~

8. Principals agreed that, in light of increased media speculation about peace plan implementation, we needed to step up consultations with the Congress on our overall Bosnia strategy, while seeking to lower expectations of an immediate breakthrough in the negotiations. Calls to key Members should take place at the beginning of the week of September 25, followed by a Presidential meeting with Senate and House leadership. (Action: NSC/State) ~~(S)~~

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